

A photograph of a mosque at night. The central focus is three arched windows with intricate geometric patterns, illuminated from within. The windows are set into a dark, textured wall. The entire scene is reflected in a pool of water in the foreground. The lighting is a mix of warm yellow from the interior lights and cool blue from the ambient night light.

Amit Erez | Photography

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50 tips for better photography

A practical beginner-friendly guide to composition, light and camera settings — with examples from Amit Erez's portfolio and links for deeper learning.

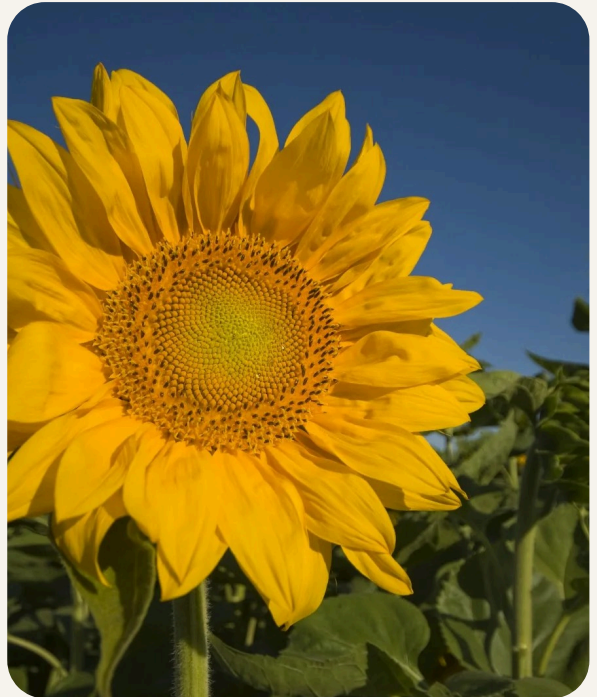
How to use this guide

The key idea

Settings are tools. Before aperture, ISO or shutter speed, ask what you want the viewer to notice, feel and remember.

Turn it into practice

- Shoot the same scene from three positions.
- Compare exposures, not only final images.
- Inspect the edges of every frame.
- Revisit the shot after editing and ask what you would do differently.



You do not need to memorize 50 rules. Pick two or three tips for each shoot, practice them deliberately, then add more.



Quick beginner glossary

Aperture

The opening inside the lens. It affects light and depth of field.

ISO

The camera's sensitivity setting. Higher ISO helps in low light but can add digital noise.

Panning

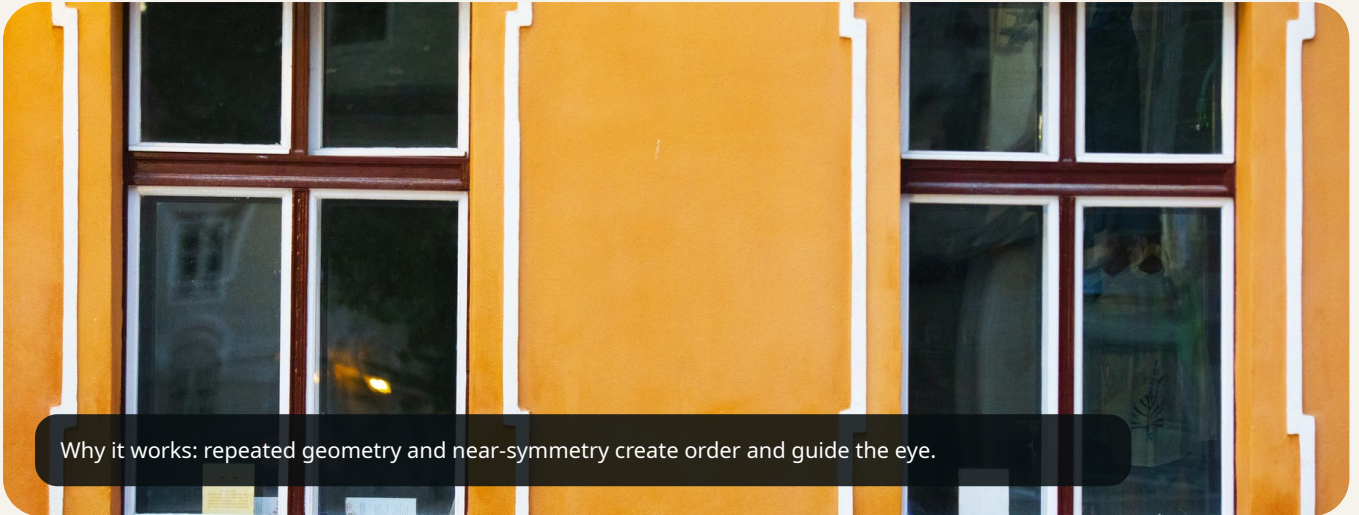
Following a moving subject with the camera so the subject stays relatively sharp while the background shows motion.

Shutter speed

How long the sensor is exposed to light. Fast speeds freeze motion; slow speeds can blur it.

Depth of field

How much of the area in front of and behind the focus point appears sharp.



Composition

Build the frame before touching the settings

01

01 Decide what the main subject is before changing camera settings.

02 Clean the edges of the frame; small distractions often weaken a strong photo.

03 Change your position before zooming. Half a meter can transform the composition.

04 The rule of thirds is a starting point, not a law. Use it only when it serves the story.

05 Look for foreground, middle ground and background to create depth.

06 Symmetry is powerful when it is precise and intentional.

07 Use negative space when it strengthens the subject, not just to fill the frame.

08 Use lines, frames and repetition to guide the viewer through the image.

[Read the full guide](#)

Photo from Amit Erez's portfolio



Light & exposure

Let the light decide what matters

09

09 Check the direction of the light before deciding on exposure.

10 At golden hour, look for side light rather than only shooting toward the sun.

11 Side light reveals texture, volume and shape.

12 Protect important highlights; shadow detail is often easier to recover.

13 Use exposure compensation when the camera makes the scene too bright or too dark.

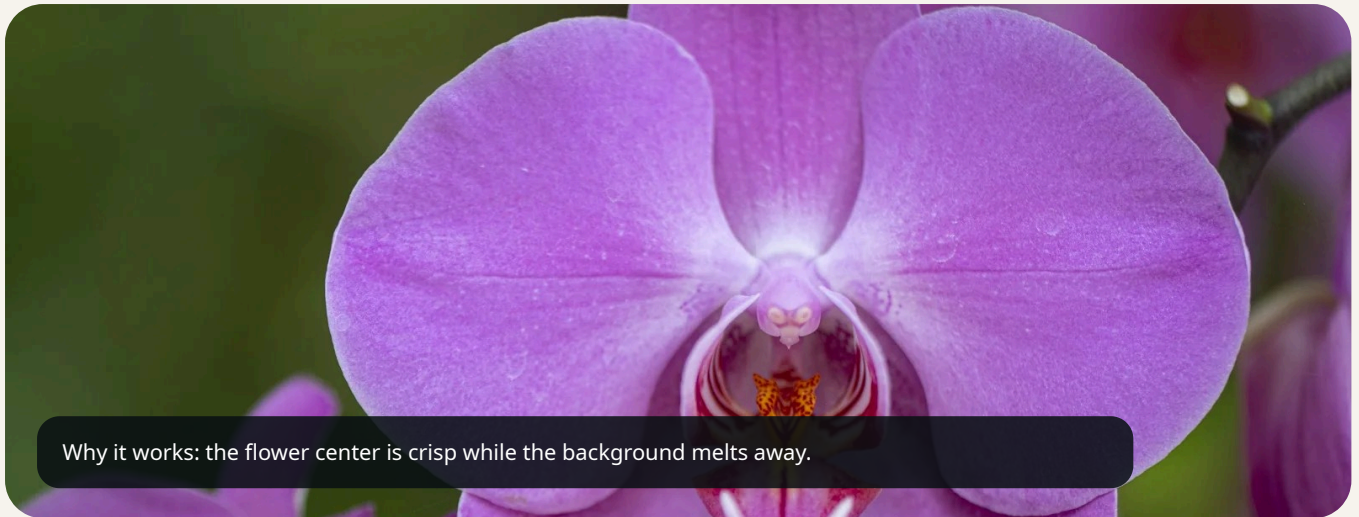
14 Use the histogram, especially when the rear screen is misleading in bright daylight.

15 ISO is a tool, not an enemy. A sharp image with some noise beats a blurred clean image.

16 Aperture and shutter speed should serve your intention, not a supposedly perfect number.

[Read the full guide](#)

Photo from Amit Erez's portfolio



Why it works: the flower center is crisp while the background melts away.

Focus & sharpness

17

Sharpness in the right place matters more than sharpness everywhere

17 Place focus on the critical detail: an eye, texture or important edge.

18 For a still subject, use a precise focus point instead of a broad automatic area.

19 For movement, switch to continuous autofocus and begin tracking before the moment.

20 When hand-holding, raise shutter speed as focal length increases.

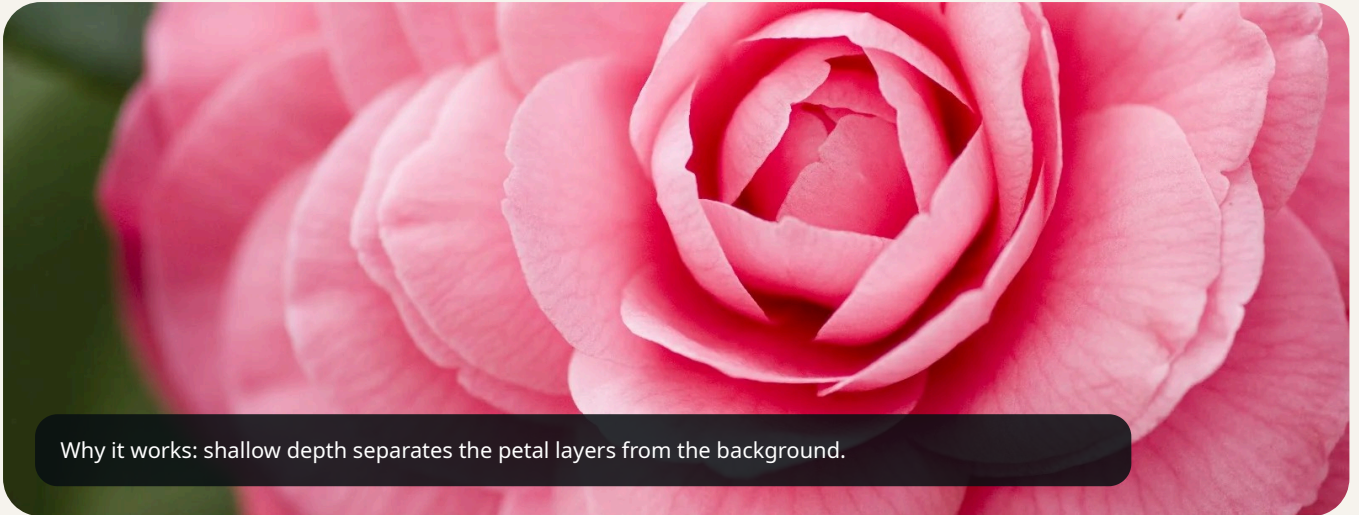
21 Brace your elbows and use a wall, railing or bag for support.

22 Use short bursts for movement instead of endless high-speed shooting.

23 Do not rely on aggressive sharpening later; good sharpening begins with good focus.

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Depth of field & macro

24

Choose what is sharp — and what is not

24 Shallow depth of field is a separation tool, not a goal by itself.

25 Increase subject-to-background distance for cleaner blur.

26 In macro, move millimeters forward and backward instead of trusting autofocus alone.

27 Keep the camera plane parallel to the detail you want to keep sharp.

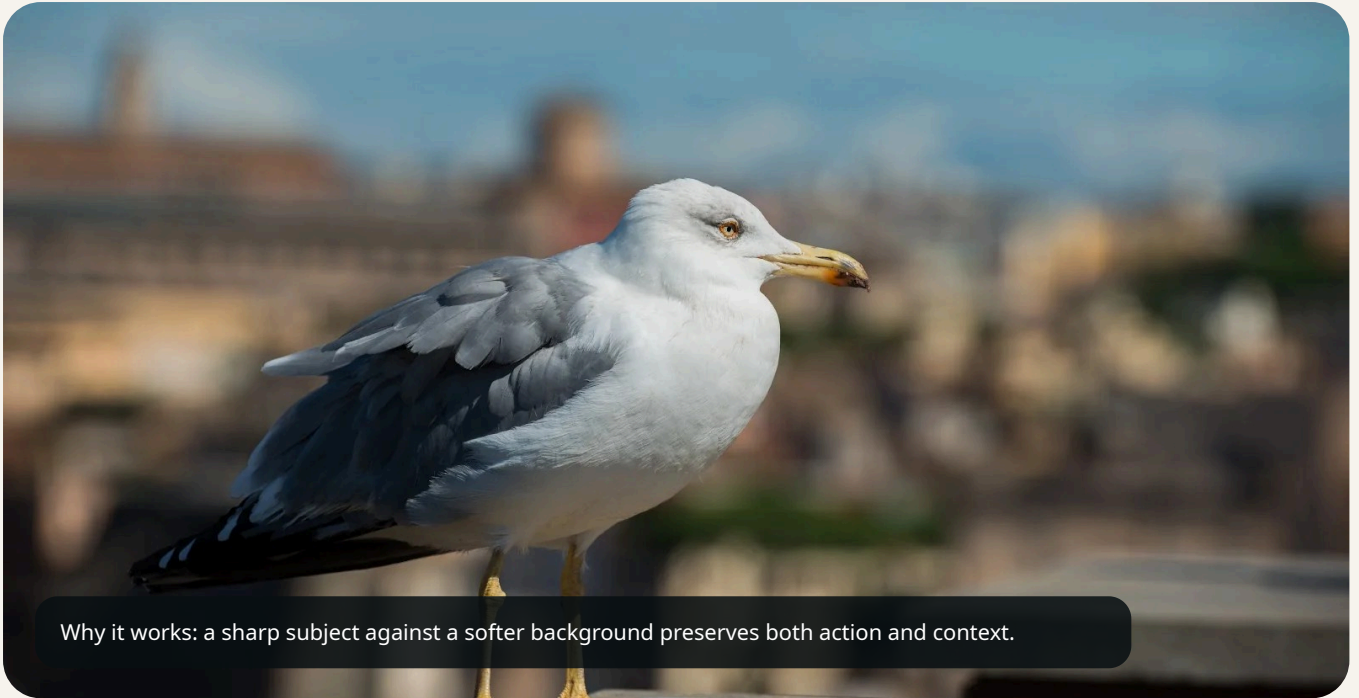
28 Stopping down adds depth of field, but very small apertures can soften detail.

29 Look for soft light in macro; clouds and open shade are excellent diffusers.

30 Inspect the background before pressing the shutter; one bright spot can steal attention.

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Why it works: a sharp subject against a softer background preserves both action and context.

Motion & timing

Shutter speed matters — anticipation matters too

31

31 To freeze action, raise shutter speed until the important detail stays crisp.

32 When panning, continue the movement smoothly after pressing the shutter.

33 Start tracking a moving subject before it reaches the best point in the frame.

34 Wait for the peak moment: an open wing, a glance, a step or a splash.

35 Stay one second after the obvious moment; the stronger picture often happens just after it.

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Why it works: architectural lines and scale lead the eye toward the center of the frame.

Landscape & architecture

Order, depth and scale

36

36 Build landscapes in three layers: foreground, middle ground and background.

37 Return to the same place in different light; weather is part of the subject.

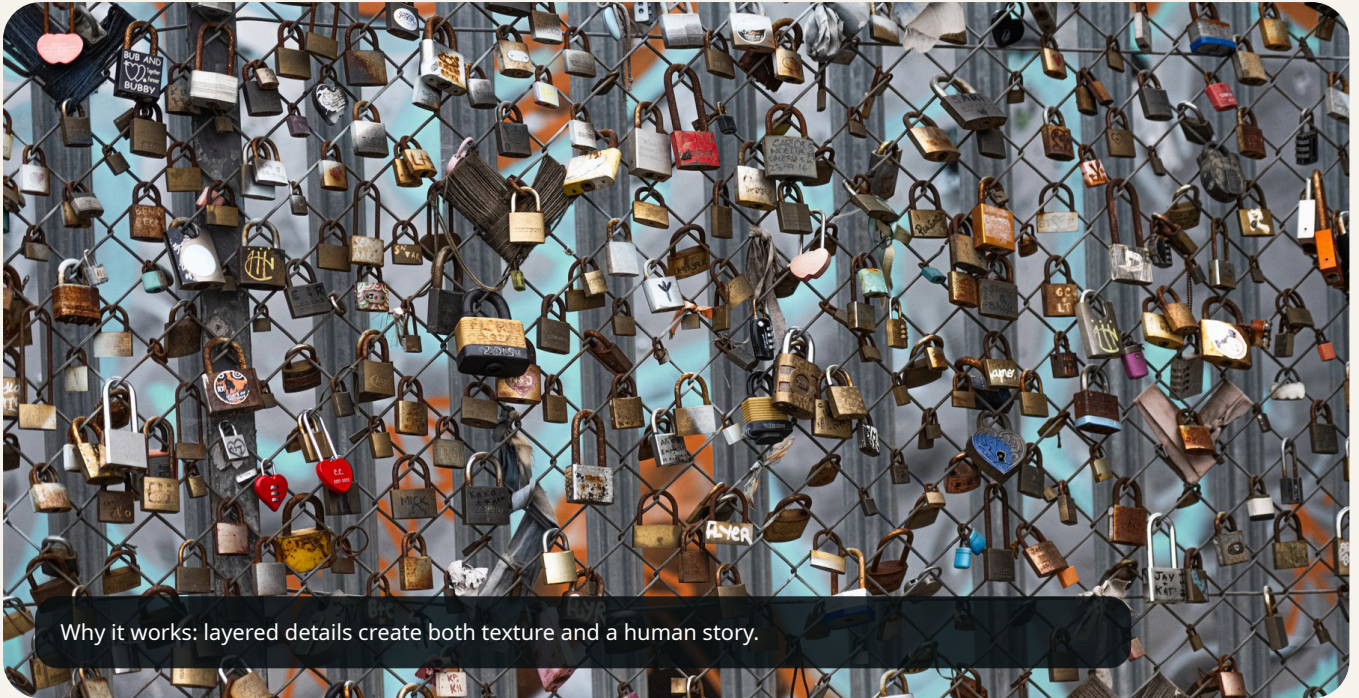
38 Include an element of scale when viewers have no other way to understand size.

39 In architecture, decide whether verticals are straight or intentionally converging.

40 Check all four corners before shooting a building; most distractions hide there.

[Read the full guide](#)

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Why it works: layered details create both texture and a human story.

Portrait & storytelling

A strong picture tells us something about the person or place

41

41 In portraits, look for light in the eyes before chasing a perfect background.

42 Move the person relative to the light, not only the camera relative to the person.

43 Keep some environment when it adds information and story.

44 In street photography, wait for a gesture, glance or coincidence that connects the elements.

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Why it works: the blue atmosphere remains intact while bright architectural detail is preserved.

Night & color

Keep the atmosphere without losing detail

45

45 At night, use a tripod when useful, but also ask whether slight movement adds atmosphere.

46 With long exposures, watch signs, lamps and other highlights that clip quickly.

47 Choose white balance intentionally; do not automatically neutralize every warm or cool tone.

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Why it works: color, rhythm and shape are the subject - editing should strengthen them, not replace them.

Black & white and editing

Good editing strengthens a decision already made in camera

48

48 Choose black and white when light, shape and texture matter more than color.

49 Prefer subtle local adjustments over heavy global contrast.

50 Crop last, and ask whether the crop strengthens the story or simply hides a problem.

[Read the full guide](#)

Photo from Amit Erez's portfolio

A recommended practice path

Want the tips to become habits? Work through these four steps over two weeks.



1

Composition

Spend one session barely changing settings — only position, angle and framing.

[Open guide](#)

2

Light & exposure

Photograph the same subject with front, side and back light and compare.

[Open guide](#)

3

Focus & depth

Build a series where the viewer always knows exactly what is meant to be sharp.

[Open guide](#)

4

Night & editing

Shoot at night, edit gently, and compare the final image with the original file.

[Open guide](#)

Keep learning — and keep shooting

This guide is a starting point. The site has galleries, in-depth guides, photo breakdowns, locations and videos.



Galleries & photographs

Selected work by subject and location.

All photography guides

Exposure, composition, light, focus, macro, night and more.

Photo breakdowns

Why an image works, what to learn from it and how it was made.

Photo locations in Israel

Ideas and practical guidance for places to shoot.

Photography videos

Explanations, demonstrations and watchable learning.

The most important tip: go shoot

Pick one idea from the guide, take it into one real shoot, and return to the site when you want to go deeper.

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